Functions

The functions of the Commission are as follows:

1. To identify laws which are no longer needed or relevant and can be immediately repealed
2. To examine the existing laws in the light of Directive Principles of State Policy and suggest ways of improvement and reform and also suggest such legislations as might be necessary to implement the Directive Principles and to attain the objectives set out in the Preamble of the Constitution
3. To consider and convey to the Government its views on any subject relating to law and judicial administration that may be specifically referred to it by the Government
4. To consider the requests for providing research to any foreign countries as may be referred to it by the Government
5. To take all such measures as may be necessary to harness law and the legal process in the service of the poor
6. To revise the Central Acts of general importance so as to simplify them and remove anomalies, ambiguities and inequities

Working

The working of the Commission consists of the following stages:

1. The projects undertaken by the Commission are initiated in its meetings.
2. Priorities are discussed, topics are identified and preparatory work is assigned to the members.
3. Different methodologies for collection of data and research are adopted keeping in view the scope of the proposed reform.
4. A working paper, outlining the problem and suggesting matters deserving reform, emerges as the outcome.
5. This paper is sent out for circulation in the public and concerned interest groups with a view to eliciting reactions and suggestions
6. Responses are evaluated and the information is organised for proper incorporation in the report
7. The report is subjected to close scrutiny by the full Commission in prolonged meetings for its finalisation.
8. The final report is forwarded to the Government (Ministry of Law and Justice)

The reports of the Commission are considered by the Ministry of Law and Justice in consultation with the concerned administrative ministries and are submitted to Parliament from time to time.

Till now, the Commission submitted 277 reports on different subjects. The reports submitted by the 21st Commission are mentioned in Table 70.3.